SYED HASSAN AHMED

GRC Analyst | IT Risk & Compliance | Information Security | Cloud Security (AWS)

Karachi, Pakistan | +92 333 2124852 | s.hassanahmed93@gmail.com

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/syed-hassan-ahmed-a333bba2 | GitHub: github.com/shassanahmed93-rgb

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) analyst with a 10-year background in regulated broadcast media, now focused on IT risk management, information security compliance, and cloud security. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, Empire Certified GRC Analyst (ECGRC), and CyberExam Certified GRC Practitioner, with training in ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Implementation, ISO/IEC 27701 (Lead Auditor), SOC 2, NIST CSF 2.0, NIST RMF, and PCI DSS 4.0.1. Created a GRC portfolio project (GitHub) covering an ISO 31000 risk register, ISMS scope, ISO 27001 Annex A control mapping, security policies, and a GDPR privacy gap assessment. Brings a decade of applied governance experience from a regulated industry: writing and enforcing SOPs, making risk-based decisions under legal and regulatory exposure, managing incident escalation, and briefing executives and regulators. Seeking a GRC Analyst, IT Risk Analyst, Compliance Analyst, or Information Security Analyst role.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Governance & Risk:** Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC), Enterprise & IT Risk Management, Risk Assessment & Treatment, Risk Registers, Control Assessment, Third-Party / Vendor Risk Management, Key Risk Indicators (KRIs), Risk Appetite & Scoring, IT Governance, Security Policies & Standards
- **Frameworks & Standards:** ISO/IEC 27001:2022 (ISMS Implementation), ISO/IEC 27701 (PIMS), NIST CSF 2.0, NIST RMF, SOC 2, PCI DSS 4.0.1, COBIT, ISO 31000, GDPR, HIPAA
- **Compliance & Audit:** Policy & Procedure Development, Statement of Applicability (SoA), Annex A Control Mapping, Gap Assessment, Internal Audit Support, Audit Evidence & Documentation, ISMS/PIMS Auditing, SOC 2 Readiness, Compliance Monitoring, Data Privacy & Protection, Regulatory Compliance, Security Awareness Training, AI Governance
- **Cloud Security:** AWS Cloud Fundamentals, AWS Shared Responsibility Model, Identity & Access Management (IAM), Cloud Security & Compliance, Cloud Governance, Cloud Cost Management
- **Security Operations:** SIEM Monitoring, Vulnerability Assessment, Incident Response Coordination, Network Security Analysis, Penetration Testing Fundamentals, Web Application Security (SQL Injection), Linux
- **Professional:** Stakeholder Management, Executive & Regulator Communication, Crisis Management, Technical Writing & Documentation, Team Leadership, Project Management

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02)** – Amazon Web Services (AWS)
- **Empire Certified GRC Analyst (ECGRC)** – Empire Cybersecurity | Credential ID: EC-3C0FFC29D619
- **Certified GRC Practitioner – GRC Fundamentals** – CyberExam | Credential ID: CERT-2026-29111
- **ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Implementation** – Empire Cybersecurity | Credential ID: Z9UO-DC50-X2E7-X95Q
- **ISO/IEC 27701 Lead Auditor (Training Course)** – Mastermind
- **SOC 2 Compliance and Readiness** – Empire Cybersecurity
- **NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0** – Empire Cybersecurity
- **PCI DSS 4.0.1 Implementation and Validation** – Empire Cybersecurity
- **GRC Foundations** – ISC2
- **Managing Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC)** – Kennesaw State University
- **GRC Fundamentals** – Packt
- **AI Security & Governance Certified**
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** – Google / Coursera
- **Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career** – Cisco
- **Cybersecurity Analyst Program (Red & Blue Team Operations)** – Udemy

PROJECTS

Enterprise Risk Register and ISO 27001 ISMS Documentation Set github.com/shassanahmed93-rgb

Fictional global food manufacturer (6,200 employees, 14 plants, 9 countries)

- Built an ISO 31000-aligned enterprise risk register of 75 risks across 13 categories (56 cyber), with 5x5 inherent and residual scoring, risk appetite checks, treatment plans, owners, and key risk indicators (KRIs).
- Wrote a risk assessment summary for leadership: 12 risks outside appetite, ransomware as the top residual risk, 22 risks relying on weak controls, and 4 overdue treatment actions.

- Mapped register risks to all 93 ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Annex A controls in a formula-driven workbook (draft Statement of Applicability) and defined the ISMS scope under clauses 4.1 to 4.3.
- Drafted Access Control and Incident Response policies tied to Annex A controls and register KRIs, including joiner/mover/leaver rules, privileged access, severity levels, and the 72-hour GDPR notification clock.
- Performed a GDPR-based privacy gap assessment across 18 requirements, with a prioritised remediation roadmap.

Journal API on AWS: Terraform, EKS, CI/CD, OpenTelemetry github.com/shassanahmed93-rgb/journal-starter

FastAPI and PostgreSQL journaling API with AI-powered entry analysis, deployed to AWS

- Deployed the API to AWS with Terraform (infrastructure as code) on Amazon EKS behind an Application Load Balancer with an ACM TLS certificate.
- Built an automated GitHub Actions pipeline (test, build, deploy) using OIDC federation to ECR and EKS with no long-lived keys; passed on main with a recorded production deployment. Added OpenTelemetry observability (dashboard, X-Ray traces, alarms).
- Secured the environment: RDS in private subnets reachable only from the app tier, secrets in AWS Secrets Manager, an admin token on destructive endpoints, and SSO with a restricted EKS API for administrators.
- Verified live: an independent Learn to Cloud verifier confirmed the public HTTPS API (create entry, AI analysis, and /version matching the deployed commit). Resources were deleted afterwards to avoid ongoing cost.
- Documented a known limitation (shared bearer tokens) and the fix: Cognito/OIDC with per-user data isolation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BOL Network – Karachi, Pakistan **Sep 2016 – Present**

Lead News Producer *Sep 2019 – Present*

- Lead editorial governance for daily live and recorded news broadcasts, setting content standards and making real-time, risk-based publishing decisions under legal and regulatory exposure.
- Author and enforce standard operating procedures (SOPs) for editorial workflows, incident escalation, and crisis coverage, ensuring consistent, documented decision-making across teams and shifts.
- Coordinate escalation during breaking news and crisis events, verifying information, assessing legal and reputational risk, and briefing senior leadership for decisions.
- Serve as primary liaison between the newsroom, senior management, external stakeholders, and regulatory bodies, ensuring accurate and compliant information flow under time pressure.
- Lead and mentor cross-functional production teams, aligning priorities and resources against strict, non-negotiable on-air deadlines.

Program Manager *Jul 2017 – Sep 2019*

- Managed end-to-end delivery of broadcast programs, coordinating internal teams and external stakeholders to ensure on-time, compliant execution.
- Monitored risk and quality control across simultaneous productions, identifying issues early and driving corrective action before broadcast.

Producer *Dec 2016 – Jul 2017*

- Planned and produced news segments, verifying content accuracy and ensuring adherence to editorial and regulatory standards.

Associate Producer *Sep 2016 – Nov 2016*

- Supported senior producers with content research, source verification, and production logistics.

XLO (Xport Left Overs) – Karachi, Pakistan **Jul 2020 – Mar 2022**

Founder & Business Owner (E-commerce Apparel)

- Founded and operated an e-commerce apparel brand, managing supplier relationships, daily operations, and customer-facing risk including fraud prevention and dispute resolution.

Souda Ghar – Karachi, Pakistan **Jan 2021 – May 2021**

Senior Marketing Executive

- Owned brand P&L and marketing strategy for an online grocery platform, balancing growth objectives against operational and reputational risk.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (MA), Mass Communication / Media Studies **2016**

University of Karachi

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Mass Communication / Media Studies **2015**

University of Karachi